

WHAT DO YOU REALLY KNOW ABOUT LIVEABOARD

25 TIPS FOR DIVERS WHO ARE GOING TO ATTEND THEIR LIVEABOARD

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25 tips for divers who are going to attend their liveaboard

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You are a diver and have decided to “take a giant step” into the world of liveaboards.
You’re in the right place.

You’re probably wondering what a liveaboard actually is and how it all works.

At its core, it’s a boat with cabins where divers live and dive for several days — sometimes weeks.

If there’s one part of diving I’ve never enjoyed, it’s the routine: assembling your gear, hauling it to the boat, getting to the dive site, gearing up, then reversing the whole process — and doing it again the next day. And the day after that, if you dive from shore.

A liveaboard removes all of that.

You simply live on the water — and dive from there.

You reach remote dive sites, stay away from crowded coastal diving, and step out of the noise completely.

I like liveaboards. Enough to have a long list of boats I still want to get on — and places I would return to more than once. (I can share — **V.P.**)

The Red Sea sits high on that list.

After years of diving, teaching, and running safaris in different parts of the world, there are a few things I’ve learned that make a real difference.

These are the things that make a liveaboard easier, safer, and simply better.

So let’s take a simple scenario: you’re heading on a liveaboard in the Red Sea.

So ... are you ready to read **25 TIPS** and
«LIVEABOARD PACKING LIST» ?

Here we go…

1.Choose the route that suits you

Dive safari itineraries in the Red Sea are usually divided into two main groups: Northern routes and Southern routes.

NORTH routes mean more wrecks, fewer walls and cliffs, a diverse underwater environment, and shorter transfers from the airport (most trips start from Hurghada).

These routes can be adapted for different experience levels, so they work well even if this is your first liveaboard.



SOUTH routes are more about walls, cliffs, current diving, and deeper dives, with fewer wrecks.

There is more marine life here, including larger species and sharks, but transfers can take longer depending on the departure port (Port Ghalib, Marsa Alam, or Hamata).



In general, Southern routes are suitable for beginners, although in some places it may be more difficult to organise dives for divers with limited experience due to strong currents.

Just be ready to skip a few dives, relax and sunbathe.

I'll tell you a secret — staying on the boat while everyone is diving is a unique feeling. In general, this is my dream! Just imagine… you, the captain and the cook… a great combination! (**V.P.**)

Prices and schedules for liveaboards in Egypt for different routes can be found **HERE**.

Using filters and search, you can choose the route, the boat and the dates that suit you.

If you haven't decided yet, just leave an application on the same page.
A reservation manager will contact you and answer all your questions.

2. Prepare your passport and certificate

Passport — useful for crossing borders. Make sure there are two free pages available for the Egyptian visa, which is issued on arrival at the airport. The visa costs $25 — check current details before departure.

It is important to check the expiration date of your passport in advance. At the time of your trip, the passport must be valid for at least 6 months. It will take 2 blank pages for the Egyptian stamp and visa. Check in advance — you may need to get a new passport. It's unpleasant to find this out a week before the trip.

Diver's certificate — don't forget to take it with you. Logbook too. If you use electronic versions, make sure they are saved offline.

3. Book a hotel to stay on the shore

You may want to spend one or more days ashore — before or after the dive safari. Good idea. Take a couple of excursions, walk around souvenir shops, or just relax on the beach.

Check with the booking manager. They know what to do ashore and will give you recommendations.
In addition, they can offer hotel accommodation options at a special price and help you plan all the necessary transfers.



4. Check the time and conditions of the yacht transfer

Transfer from the airport to the яхта and back is usually included.

Check in advance how you will meet the company representatives at the airport and provide your flight details if you are arriving on your own.

Yachts usually leave the marina on Sunday morning and return to the port on Friday in the second half of the day.

Check-in on the яхта: for those staying in a hotel — in the morning on the day of departure; for divers arriving by flight — in the evening the day before.

Departure from the яхта: transfer to the hotel or airport is arranged on the day the яхта returns to port. Those departing at night are usually taken to the airport additionally.

5. Choose the right cabin when booking

If you have the option to choose a cabin (if the “best” ones are not yet occupied), pay attention to the lower deck cabins in the middle of the boat.

Firstly, it moves less — the sea always moves, even when it seems calm.

Secondly, they are farther from the engine room, which means less noise from engines and compressors.



You can choose different cabins for different routes.

On southern routes, the boat rolls more — reefs are farther from the coast and passages are longer. If you're like me and don't worry too much about seasickness, there are great upper deck cabins.

Another point — there are fewer "passing" people here, and the upper deck, where you can lie down and sunbathe, is closer. Evening gatherings are usually there as well.

And in general — you step out in the morning, and the sea is all around… good.

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6. Take some cash

Cards are not accepted everywhere, and there are no ATMs at sea, so there are situations when cash is really needed. For example, when buying souvenirs or giving tips.

It's better to thank the crew for the safari in cash (see the amount below).

Everything else — transfers, accommodation on the boat, food and diving — is usually included in the price of the dive safari.

7. Pack light

You will spend most of your time in a swimsuit or wetsuit.

Shorts, T-shirts, a pareo, and something warmer for the evening — this is enough for a dive safari.

8. Don’t forget warm clothes

By the end of the day, when you want to sit with friends on the upper deck, it can get cool. Take a sweatshirt or a light jacket with you.

Don’t take too much — one or two items are enough. Remember, this takes up space in your luggage, and it’s better to travel light.

9. Bring a solar charger

There will be a lot of sun on a dive safari.

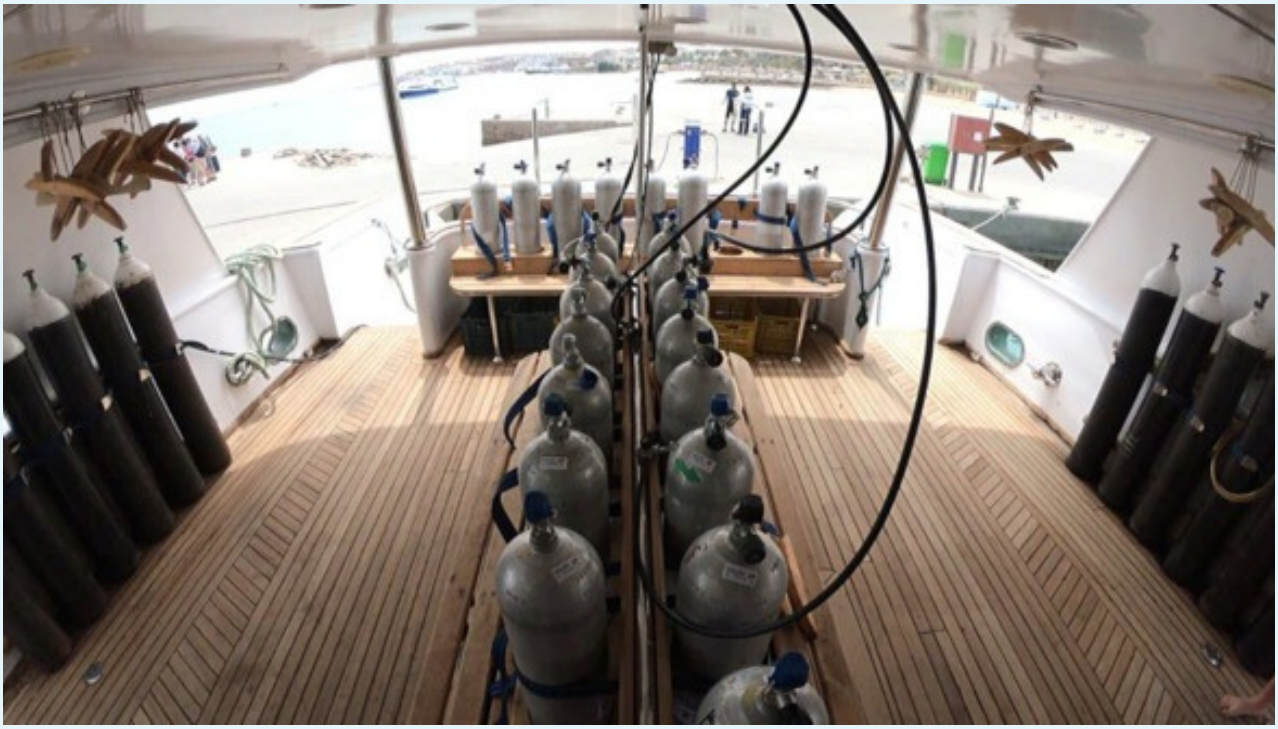
It’s a convenient way to charge your phone and other devices — you won’t have to keep going back to your cabin when you need to charge something.

Such devices are inexpensive, and the benefit is obvious.

10. Bring a few swimsuits with you

You will spend the week in swim trunks or a swimsuit and a wetsuit — quite often.

It’s good to have a dry swimsuit to change into after each dive.



Take a few, change them, and don’t walk around in wet clothes in the wind — it’s unpleasant and you get cold quickly.

11. Bring a spare parts kit



Take a few essentials with you: spare batteries, bulbs, straps for masks and fins, and other small items for your equipment. There is a lot on the boat, but it’s better to be on the safe side.

A dead battery or a lost camera clip can ruin an entire dive.

If you’re missing something, don’t hesitate to contact your dive guide — they will help solve the problem.

12. Prepare your equipment and refresh your skills

Check and service your equipment before the trip. Finding a leak in your dry suit or a malfunctioning regulator on your first dive is not the best situation.

If you’ve bought new equipment, try it in advance — at least in a pool.

If possible, take a pool session before the trip or simply refresh your basic skills on your own.



I also recommend getting and testing an **SMB** in advance so you can calmly do your safety stops while hovering near the reef at 5 meters.

It's convenient — you can keep watching the fish while the zodiac is already approaching, ориентируясь на ваш буй.

Do you confidently enter the water from a zodiac? Great. Refresh this skill before your dive safari.

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13. Use a DRY BAG for wet gear

Your equipment may not have time to dry before departure. Packing wet gear together with the rest of your things is not a good idea.

Use a **DRY BAG — a lightweight waterproof bag.**

Put your wet gear in it, and then pack it together with your other вещи.

Your personal belongings will stay dry.

And remember — wet gear weighs more. This will affect the total weight of your luggage during the flight.

14. Get the right insurance

I only work with diving insurance.

Standard travel insurance does not cover transportation and treatment in a decompression chamber — and this becomes critical when something happens.

Get specialized insurance for divers. Pay attention to coverage: evacuation, treatment, delays or loss of baggage and equipment, flight cancellations, and missed diving days.

If you need a specific option, take a look at **DiveAssure.** This is one of the working options I've used without problems.

15. Be careful with the tropical sun

The sun in Egypt is strong all year round, especially during the high diving season (August — October).

During the day, it's better to stay in the shade — in the saloon or on the covered deck.

Bring a waterproof sunscreen with a high SPF. SPF 30 and above with UVA and UVB protection is a good choice.

To reduce luggage weight, you can buy it on arrival.



16. Sea sickness

Even the largest and most stable yachts roll in open sea. Especially on long passages to remote dive sites.

That's why it's better to start taking seasickness tablets in advance — the evening before heading out to sea.



I think… you want to dive with the fish, not feed them!)

17. Take care of your ears

Diving with sore ears is no pleasure. Keep your ears dry.

There are special drops — your dive guide will advise you. You can also carefully dry your ears after the dive with a hairdryer.

Just don’t overdo it — don’t get burned.

18. Be a responsible diver

The underwater world is unique and beautiful. We have the opportunity to observe it without interfering. Remember one simple rule: we leave only bubbles, we take only memories.

Ask yourself: can you complete a dive with your arms folded on your chest?

If not — pay attention to buoyancy control. This can be practiced right during the dive safari.



Don’t feed the fish.
And calmly explain this to those who do — there is no benefit in it.

19. Don’t miss your first dive



The first dive, depending on the route, can be very early. You want to sleep — but just don’t miss it.

Early in the morning, with the first rays of the sun, the reef wakes up… some fish go hunting, others hide from predators.

Fish that were sleepy right in front of you become active — and it’s a completely different feeling.

Stories of those who went on the first dive are always impressive.

It’s better to tell them yourself than hear them from others.)

20. Don’t overdo it (in diving and socially)



Of course, you want to dive as much as possible — if you have the energy, do it.

But don’t overdo it. Sometimes it makes sense to skip a couple of dives and just relax.

If you decide to skip a dive, check with your dive guide. They will tell you which dives are worth not missing.

A yacht is an enclosed space. You can get tired not only from diving, but also from constant communication.

If you want to be alone — just go to your cabin or, for example, put on headphones.

Sometimes it’s better to go to bed an hour or two earlier than the others — read and спокойно finish the day.

21. Use a dive computer



Bring it with you or rent one — it will allow you to dive more often, more calmly and more safely.

This is especially important if you plan to dive on Nitrox.

Bottom time, surface interval, saturation, and time before your flight — all this information will always be at hand during your dive safari.

22. Use Nitrox to the maximum

Nitrox in recreational diving is an additional level of safety. It allows you to stay underwater longer and reduces surface intervals between dives.

Using Nitrox, you get less tired, even with several dives per day.

All you need is a Nitrox certification, the gas itself, and a dive computer.

If you already have a certification, take it with you. If not, you can complete a Nitrox course during the dive safari.



23. Use a dive safari to continue your training

A dive safari is a great opportunity to improve your skills. In the end, the main resource here is real dives that you do every day.

You dive daily, add a bit of theory with an experienced instructor — and the next level is already there.

Which one exactly depends on your goals. Deep dives, wrecks, or night dives — the choice is yours.



I recommend paying attention to Nitrox and buoyancy control courses.

This combination gives noticeable advantages, especially if you dive with a camera: longer, more often, and safer — both for you and for the reef.

24. Respect and tipping

On a dive safari, it is customary to thank the crew and dive guides — the quality of your trip and the safety of your dives directly depend on them.

It is considered good practice to leave a tip at the end of the safari.

And remember names. Anyone appreciates being addressed by name, not “hey”.

If you leave a review, it’s better to mention specific people. This is valued by both the crew and the owners.

25. Leave enough time before your flight

Remember that you cannot fly immediately after diving. Plan a dive-free day before returning home.

Use this time calmly: rest, walk around, see something, or buy souvenirs.

That’s it.
What comes next — is your experience.

Useful resources

LIVEABOARDS:

- Maldives
- Thailand
- Indonesia
- Philippines
- Egypt
- Micronesia
- Mexico
- Galapagos

ALL DESTINATIONS (A–Z)

EQUIPMENT:

- Masks
- Fins
- Wetsuits
- BCD
- Regulators
- Dive computers
- Bags

Special offers

ALL SCUBA EQUIPMENT (A–Z)

DIVER'S PACKING LIST FOR A LIVEABOARD

✧ ✧ ✧

© VITALY PUZIRYOV
(SSI Instructor Trainer)



Contacts:
Telegram — @VPuziryov
Email — v.puziryov@gmail.com